

# 023 Make a fossil mud pie

2  
HRS

Professional fossil hunters spend weeks slowly removing layers of soil from fossils so the fossils stay intact. Do you have what it takes to be a fossil hunter? Make a fossil mud pie, swap it with a friend's, and find out!

**What you need**

- Objects to bury
- Garden soil • Shovel
- Bucket • Mug • Trowel
- Water • Old mixing bowl or large plastic container • Paintbrush
- Tweezers

**1** Collect bones, shells, or man-made items like coins to bury. Put three shovelfuls of soil in a bucket. Break the soil up with a shovel, then crumble it with your hands. Remove twigs, stones, or other debris.

*Brush gently*

**2** Add six mugfuls of soil to the bowl. Add half a mugful of water and mix into very thick mud with your hands. Add more water if needed to make a thick, but not runny, mud that will set well.



*Slowly reveal your fossil*

**3** Bury your objects in the mud. Put the bowl in a dry place and let the mud set. Swap your bowl with a friend's and excavate!

**4** Carefully remove the soil with the trowel, working from the outside in. Brush away loose soil. Lift fragile objects with tweezers.

# 024 Hunt for fossils

20  
MINS

You can find fossils anywhere—even in the gravel near your home. Look for fossils in stones, on beaches, chalk cliffs, limestone hills, or riverbanks.



*Ammonites*